Colossians 1:9–14 — Leader / Learner Guide

Paul's Prayer for the Colossians · a one-page guide for leaders and learners

Christ Is All — A Study of Colossians · TheGospelVault.com · @iJohn.316 (Instagram)

① Big Idea and Context

Big idea: Paul prays that believers be filled with the knowledge of God's will so they may walk worthy of the Lord, and he grounds that walk in what the Father has already done.

Thanksgiving (1:3–8) now becomes petition. "For this reason" looks back to the Colossians' faith and love and ahead to the false teachers' offer of "deeper knowledge."

- **The foundation:** full knowledge (*epignōsis*) with spiritual wisdom and understanding.
- **The structure:** a walk worthy of the Lord, pleasing Him in all respects.
- **The outer part:** fruit, growth, power for endurance and patience, and thanksgiving.

② A Prayer Built Like a House — Three Anchor Verses

Verse	What it says	Teaching point
1:9	*"filled with the knowledge of His will in all spiritual wisdom and understanding"*	True knowledge, not Gnostic add-ons, is the foundation.
1:10	*"walk in a manner worthy of the Lord, to please Him in all respects"*	Knowledge aims at conduct; the walk responds to grace already given.
1:13–14	*"He rescued us … transferred us … in whom we have redemption"*	The Father's finished work is the ground of thanksgiving and assurance.

Answering your own prayer: Paul prays for their knowledge and then writes the letter that supplies it.

Power is for go, not show: steadfastness with circumstances, patience with people, both with joy.

③ Teaching Flow

1. **The foundation (1:9)** — Unceasing prayer; knowledge, wisdom, understanding; "filled," not added to.
2. **The superstructure (1:10a)** — A worthy walk that pleases the Lord, from people already accepted.
3. **Fruit and growth (1:10b–c)** — Fruit in every good work; increasing by the knowledge of God.
4. **Power (1:11)** — Strength by His glorious might for steadfastness and patience, joyously.
5. **Thanksgiving (1:12–14)** — Qualified, rescued, transferred, redeemed: forgiveness is a present possession.

④ Clarify While Teaching

- **"Joyously":** the NASB95 attaches it to "giving thanks" (v.12); other versions attach it to "patience." Both are grammatically possible.
- **"Saints in Light":** the study takes this as the believer's present position in Christ, not only a future heavenly state.
- **Ransom "to whom?":** the study holds that the price was not paid to Satan; avoid suggesting God owed the devil anything.
- **Worthy walk:** stress that it is the fruit of salvation and the path to reward, not a condition for receiving eternal life.

⑤ Discussion and Close

1. If God answered every prayer you prayed for others last week, how would their spiritual lives be different?
2. Distinguish "steadfastness" from "patience." Which do you need more right now?
3. What does "transferred" picture, and how should it change the way a believer sees himself?

Close: Next, Paul shows us the Son into whose kingdom we were transferred: Creator, Head of the Church, and Reconciler (1:15–23). "In whom we have redemption, the forgiveness of sins."

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